

Presentation Techniques

SEAPOWER THROUGH ENGINEERING

TOPIC LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Upon successful completion of this topic, the student will be able to:

1. Recognize techniques to prepare and deliver an effective presentation.
2. Recognize the parts of a presentation and recall the objective of each part.
3. Understand how to employ visual, verbal and vocal components to ensure a successful presentation.
4. Demonstrate effective presentation techniques, per prescribed criteria, while delivering a professional briefing to staff and students.

STUDENT PREPARATION

Student Support Material

1. ICS Grading Rubric

Primary References

1. "Senior Leaders Tell How to Brief Senior Leaders"
2. "Presentation S.O.S. – From Perspiration to Persuasion"

Additional References

1. Don McMillan - "Life After Death By PowerPoint" https://youtu.be/lpvgfmEU2Ck
2. Simon Sinek – "The Golden Circle" https://youtu.be/qp0HIF3SfI4
3. See Slides 33-34 of this presentation

Overview

- Student Presentation Requirements
- Presentation Design
- Effective Delivery Techniques

Student Presentation Requirements

- Scenario
  - Collaborate with Integrated Product Teams (IPT) members on a professional brief that supports a Milestone Decision aligned with Integrated Case Study (ICS) objectives
- Execution
  - Each student will have a chance to brief
  - Apply techniques presented in this training module
  - Team briefing time will be limited to 20 minutes for each presentation
    - Each student limited to 10 minutes, and must brief a minimum of 5 slides
    - Team grade for content, and individual grade for presentation technique
  - Presentations will be video recorded
- Follow-up
  - Review your video independently for self-evaluation
  - Debrief with Director of Training (DoT) after self-evaluation

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Preparation

- First step: Audience Analysis
  - Personality type (requires more or less detail?)
  - Can you anticipate any particular questions?
  - How much background do they already have?
  - What would the target audience like to gain from the brief?
- Second step: Understand the deliverable
  - Know your desired outcome of the brief, but remember your approach must cater to the audience and their perspectives
  - From where did the original need for the brief emanate?
  - Is there a prescribed format?

"If I had 8 hours to chop down an apple tree, I'd spend 6 sharpening my ax."
- George Washington

Preparation

- Third step: Determine the purpose
  - High level, simple, and concise
  - Can be one or a combination of:
    - Inform
    - Inspire
    - Motivate
    - Persuade
    - Decision **ICS is mostly a decision brief**
  - Are you trying to gain buy-in?
    - Refer to The Golden Circle, by Simon Sinek https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mqZyg2XAmDk

Structure

- General Rule*
  - Opening – 15%
  - Body – 75%
  - Closing – 10%
- Limit slide count as much as possible
  - Slide count may be prescribed for many briefs
- Limit 4 major bullets per slide
  - Not applicable to lists
- Build in time for questions
  - Assume 3-5 minutes per slide (includes your voiceover plus questions)



* For short presentations of 30 minutes or less (opening and closing may need to be a smaller percentage for longer briefs)

Opening

- Objectives
  - Gain attention
  - Establish relevance
  - Establish credibility
  - Preview the topic
  - Provide the purpose
  - Establish expectations
    - 2 or 3 things that you want the audience to get from your brief
    - Each is a discrete thought or idea that allows audience to focus accordingly
    - Consider a BLUF statement
    - Tied to the takeaways at the end
  - ***Do not*** provide supporting details that will be contained in the body!



Sets the tone for the whole presentation

Body

- Main points
  - Provide evidence for the purpose of the brief and support the expectations
    - How many should you have?
    - Ensure all slides are consistent with your purpose
- Connectives
  - Focus on flow and transition. Each point should follow a logical transition to the next set of points
  - Plan on a verbal connective when there is no natural transition
- Patterns
  - Chronological/sequential/spatial
  - Problem/solution
  - Cause and effect

Recommending a Course of Action

- Place your recommended option either first or last in the discussion
  - Open with a statement that this is the recommended option, but avoid the hard sell at this point…that comes later
- Describe all options concisely and objectively
  - Include assumptions (or at least be prepared to discuss)
    - Clearly explain the reason for each assumption
    - What relevant factual information is unconfirmed?
    - What hazards/risks exist if the assumption is false/invalid?
    - Anticipate additional questions on your assumptions
  - Have you considered the option to maintain current course?
- Need funding?
  - Provide details on the Return on Investment (ROI)
  - Provide assumed impacts/risks if requested funding is not received

Supporting Material

- Charts/data/graphics – the simpler the better, only as much as necessary
  - Use appropriate charts and tables
    - Pie charts to show contrast
    - Vertical bar charts to show changes over time
    - Horizontal bar charts to compare quantities
    - Smart art to show relationships
  - Ensure charts have a legend, consistent units, and accurate numbers
- Bumper stickers?
  - Only if it provides clarity that is not obvious already, or to add critical emphasis to a main point
- Backup slides
  - Great for managing the amount of detail needed in the body

Closing

- Drive home the takeaways
  - Bring closure to the expectations
- The final case for the brief
  - Make the sale on recommended option (or call to action)
  - Explain why one option is recommended over the other(s)
  - If your objective was to get a decision, then ask for it here
- Leave a lasting impression on the audience
- ***Do not*** recap your entire brief!



Reinforces and connects the expectations and take-aways

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Effective Delivery Techniques

- Three components of a presentation:
  - Verbal
    - The words/content of your message
  - Vocal
    - The way the words are said
  - Visual
    - What the listener sees as you are speaking



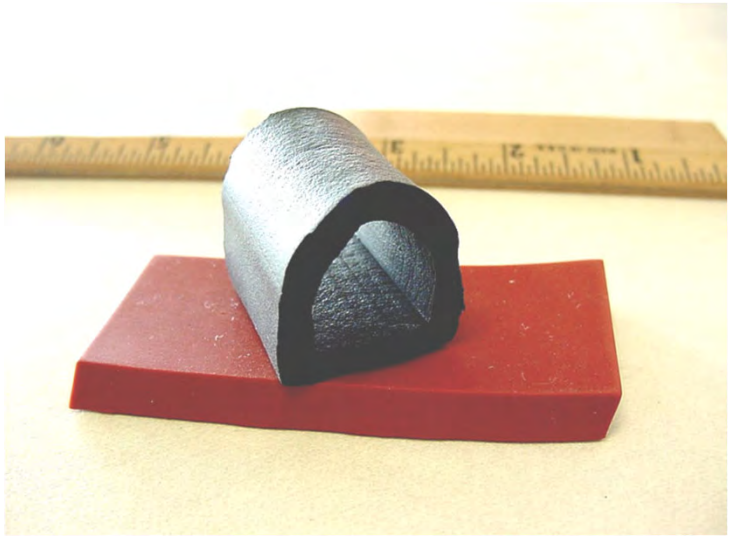
You must consider all 3 in your preparation

Visual Effects

- Use plenty of white space
- Avoid excessive animation
- Use fragments instead of full sentences where possible
- Left justify text
- Use same text color throughout the brief
  - Provide a legend for any different colors used
    - i.e., green = good, red = bad, etc.
- Ensure font is large enough for audience to read
  - Range of 16 – 24 is usually sufficient
- Spell out acronyms
- Number each slide

Visual Effects

- Photos or graphics can be great visual aids
  - Determine if the photo will help convey a main point or explain a complex issue
  - Don't overdo it
- Diagrams and Charts
  - Keep them simple
  - Eliminate unnecessary detail
  - Label them
  - Use callouts where appropriate
  - Pause 10-20 seconds when first presenting a graph



- Finalizing Your Slides
  - Display on the actual screen prior to your presentation
    - Check font size and colors from back of the room
    - Trial run animations/videos and ensure proper volume level
    - Make sure you know how to operate the equipment

Visual Effects

Do	***Don't***
– Dress appropriately	– Talk to screen
– Relax, be natural	– Show your nervousness
– Engage your audience	– Stare at one person
– Eye contact around the room	– Ignore a section of room
– Move purposefully	– Appear disorganized
– Use gestures for emphasis	– Use the pointer excessively

You are also a part of the visual element

Body Language

Posture

- Stand up straight, weight evenly distributed on both feet
- Avoid slouching, swaying, leaning on the lectern
- Nervous postures:
  - "The Stern Father"
  - "Sisters of Mercy"
  - Hands in pockets
  - "Fig leaf"
  - "Parade Rest"

Movement

- Consider moving away from lectern, at least briefly, for more audience engagement
- Use body movement to signal shift in topic, indicate a new visual, or shift focus on a visual
- Walk from the wall, out to the audience
- Avoid roots, "the caged lion," jingling objects in pockets, any movement that interferes with the visuals

Minimize the nervous clues; easier said than done, conscious effort required

Verbal Effects

Do

- Speak clearly
- Be concise
- Provide examples for clarification
- Be very careful with humor
- Inject some thought
- Speak confidently

Don't

- Get into the weeds
- Sell a car
- Read the slides
- Use excessive verbal clutter ("um," "so," "ok," "right," etc.)
- Overwhelm with data
- Use words like; "hopefully," "kinda," "maybe"

Vocal Effects

Do	***Don't***
– Project enthusiasm	– Speak in low volume
– Enunciate	– Monotone
– Command attention	– Be arrogant
– Be dynamic, deliberate, direct	– Be apathetic
– Be authentic	– Be apprehensive
– Poised	– Be unprofessional

Public Speaking Tips

- Know your stuff!
  - Bring your expert(s) to the meeting
- Be yourself
  - The more your brief is like a normal conversation, the better it will be
- Perfection is not required
  - Not a realistic expectation; the audience will forgive minor missteps
- Boost your confidence
  - Recognize the source of any anxiety and address it directly
- Adhere to time constraints
  - Have clock visible within line of sight to audience; place watch on lectern
  - Always aim to complete as efficiently as possible; no penalties for finishing early

Combating Nervousness

Performance in this area is inevitable in your line of work

- Seek opportunities to practice and improve (at least 2 such opportunities provided in this course)
- Seek feedback

Q & A Tips

- Relax!
- Respond directly and politely
  - ***P***ause before you speak
    - Feel free to repeat the question
  - ***A***lways start with your conclusion, then explain
  - ***U***se an explanation, anecdote, or illustration the audience can relate to
  - ***S***top when you've answered the question
  - ***E***nsure the audience understood your answer



Build in ample time for questions

Tough Questions

- Don’t blow smoke
  - Provide the facts
  - State what’s missing (i.e., what you need to answer accurately)
  - Provide your informed opinion (i.e., qualify your guesses)
- Look-ups are ok
- Anticipate as much as possible
  - What is the upside/downside?
  - What do the “nay-sayers” say?
  - What if we do nothing?
- Keep your briefing on track
  - Be polite, but don’t allow a “non-principal” to steal the show

Virtual Presentation Tips

- Opt for the webcam (give eye contact and stand, if possible)
  - Utilize body language to your advantage
- Ensure sufficient bandwidth for your device (OPTEST is critical)
  - Establish a dial-in option as backup
- Minimize distractions (on both ends)
  - Everyone stays mute and off camera, use hand raise function, etc.
- Interact with your audience members
  - Polls, direct questions, request feedback…frequently
  - Utilize the experience of certain audience members to gain buy-in
- Consider visual aids to enhance the presentation
  - Ensure adequate lighting and professional environment (background)
  - Utilize the chat or have someone else monitor
  - Larger fonts may be necessary
  - Remember, you are compensating for deficiencies in the visual component

Death By PowerPoint

- ***False!*** PowerPoint is never the "cause of death" of the audience
- Maybe it was:
  - A failure to connect with your audience
  - Audience unaware of expectations
  - Ineffective use of time
  - Unenthusiastic delivery
  - Inaccurate content
  - Slides too hard to follow
  - Poor sequencing
  - Too much detail
  - Too much fluff

Summary

- The first three steps of an effective presentation are…?
- What is the importance of the Purpose?
- What is the purpose of the Opening?
- What is the purpose of the Closing?
- What element of the first part of a presentation tells the audience what they gain from the brief?

Backup

Checklist

- ❑ Each slide transitions smoothly into the next slide
- ❑ Expectations and takeaways are clear
- ❑ Verified that all numbers are accurate
- ❑ All graphs and charts properly labelled
- ❑ Consistent fonts and format throughout
- ❑ All slides have page number
- ❑ Spell checked
- ❑ Acronyms are spelled out
- ❑ Tested audio/visual equipment
- ❑ Practiced the brief sufficient number of times
- ❑ Plenty of time for questions and still within allotted time



Written Communication

- Strive for clarity and conciseness in all written communication
- Consider the perspective of the receiver; tailor accordingly
- Your writing style is a reflection of yourself
  - Project positive vibes
  - Maintain professionalism
  - Grammar and spelling errors are silent killers
  - Review closely before sending
- Fact check the information you are presenting
- Be clear and direct about when a response is expected
- Phone call follow-up may be prudent

*Effective communication requires information clearly transmitted **and** correctly perceived by the recipient*

More Resources

- Opening your Brief
  - Deborah Grayson Riegel https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NyE1Kz0e--0
  - THNKR - The Speech that made Obama President https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OFPwDe22CoY
  - Jason Teteak - 5 steps to a killer opener https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dEDcc0aCjaA

- Overcoming Nervousness
  - Deborah Grayson Riegel - Overcoming Nerves When Giving a Presentation https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mbDipVRt5aE
  - Expert English - How to Deal With Presentation Stress https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ryXOW1QS0ZM
  - Amy Cody - Power Poses https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=phcDQ0H_LnY

More Resources

- Content
  - http://www.bing.com/videos/search?q=david+phillips+death+by+powerpoint&view=detail&mid=1D53C4CDA2CBCE8EF2361D53C4CDA2CBCE8EF236&FORM=VIRE

- Virtual Presentations
  - https://presentationgeeks.com/blog/virtual-presentation-best-practices/
  - https://www.forbes.com/sites/maryabbajay/2020/04/20/best-practices-for-virtual-presentations-15-expert-tips-that-work-for-everyone/?sh=614760913d19
  - https://www.timedoctor.com/blog/virtual-presentation/
  - https://www.lafabbricadellarealta.com/20-virtual-presentation-tips/